

C273

Introduction to Sociology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

At a crowded family restaurant on a Friday night, a customer in a bright red jacket takes food from a stranger's plate at the next table. Diners are shocked, the manager asks him to leave, and several people call it disgusting. No law is broken. What kind of norm did he violate?

- A. A taboo, since any food rule is unthinkable to break.
- B. A folkway.
- C. A law.
- D. A more.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A new employee eats lunch at her desk while coworkers usually eat together in the break room. A few people notice, but no one reacts beyond a raised eyebrow. What kind of norm is this?

- A. A more.
- B. A folkway.
- C. A value.
- D. A law.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 24-year-old accountant who grew up in a small coastal town joins a large firm and, over her first year, learns how to dress for client meetings, how to address partners, and when to speak in meetings. She commutes by train. What is happening?

- A. Secondary socialization by the workplace.
- B. Primary socialization by her family.
- C. Resocialization in a total institution.
- D. Nothing; socialization ends in childhood.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A sociologist who studies a suburban school district with new football stadiums argues that standardized testing mostly helps wealthier families keep their advantages, because they can pay for test prep. The district has 14 schools. Which perspective is she using?

- A. Functionalism.
- B. Symbolic interactionism.
- C. Conflict theory.
- D. Functionalism, because schools have many functions such as sports.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A researcher studies how a “gifted” label changes the way students see themselves and how teachers talk to them day to day. Which perspective fits this research?

- A. Functionalism.
- B. Structural functionalism, because labels are structures.
- C. Conflict theory.
- D. Symbolic interactionism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A mid-level bank employee who drives a used sedan and coaches youth soccer badly wants to be wealthy, a goal his culture praises. Seeing no path through promotions, he begins embezzling funds. In Merton's terms, which adaptation is this?

- A. Retreatism.
- B. Innovation.
- C. Rebellion.
- D. Ritualism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A government clerk long ago gave up on promotion but still follows every procedure exactly, day after day. Which of Merton's adaptations is this?

- A.** Ritualism.
- B.** Conformity.
- C.** Retreatism.
- D.** Innovation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A 15-year-old who plays trumpet in the school band is caught shoplifting once. Teachers, neighbors, and the local paper start calling him a “troublemaker.” Over the next year he joins other labeled teens and begins to see himself as a delinquent. His family recently moved across town. What does labeling theory call his later behavior?

- A.** A normal adjustment to moving to a new neighborhood.
- B.** Secondary deviance.
- C.** Primary deviance.
- D.** Innovation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A sales rep at a busy regional office keeps interrupting colleagues in meetings. Coworkers start rolling their eyes, joking about it, and leaving him off lunch invitations. The office recently switched to open seating. What form of social control are the coworkers using?

- A.** Informal positive sanctions.
- B.** No sanction, because no rule was written.
- C.** Informal negative sanctions.
- D.** Formal negative sanctions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of the following is an example of a formal sanction?

- A.** Coworkers praise a colleague's presentation.
- B.** Friends stop inviting someone to parties.
- C.** A company suspends an employee without pay under its written attendance policy.
- D.** A teacher frowns at a talking student.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A state licensing office with modern computers and a newly painted lobby requires three separate forms, each signed by a different clerk, before renewing a license. Staff will not skip a step even when an applicant has already provided the same information. Which idea best explains this?

- A.** Poor technology.
- B.** Proof that every bureaucracy is inefficient.
- C.** A lack of any formal rules.
- D.** Bureaucratic rigidity, where following rules becomes an end in itself.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A group founded by college students in a Midwestern city campaigns for a state law requiring paid family leave. It holds rallies, lobbies legislators, and has a popular social media page with 200,000 followers. It does not seek to change the economic system. What type of movement is it?

- A.** Reform movement.
- B.** Redemptive movement.
- C.** Alternative movement.
- D.** Revolutionary movement.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

At a crowded family restaurant ~~on a Friday night~~, a customer ~~in a bright red jacket~~ takes food from a stranger's plate at the next table. Diners are shocked, the manager asks him to leave, and several people call it disgusting. No law is broken. What kind of norm did he violate?

Target word: classify the norm **Decides:** Strong moral reaction but no state enforcement.

A	Absolute language	Taboos are the most extreme mores; this act is condemned but not unthinkable.
B	Adjacent category	Folkways draw mild reactions, not shock and removal.
C	Confusion set	The stem says no law was broken.
D	Correct	A norm with moral weight that triggers strong disapproval.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A new employee eats lunch at her desk while coworkers usually eat together in the break room. A few people notice, but no one reacts beyond a raised eyebrow. What kind of norm is this?

Target word: classify a mild norm **Decides:** Minor custom, mild reaction.

A	Inverted operation	Mores carry strong moral weight; this reaction is minimal.
B	Correct	An everyday custom whose violation draws only mild reactions.
C	Adjacent category	Values are broad ideals; norms are specific behavior rules.
D	Confusion set	No formal state rule is involved.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A 24-year-old accountant ~~who grew up in a small coastal town~~ joins a large firm and, over her first year, learns how to dress for client meetings, how to address partners, and when to speak in meetings. ~~She commutes by train.~~ What is happening?

Target word: name the process and agent **Decides:** Learning norms from the workplace as an adult.

A	Correct	Adults keep learning roles and norms from secondary agents such as employers.
B	Adjacent category	The norms are coming from the firm, not her family.
C	Confusion set	Total institutions, like prisons or boot camp, control all of life; an office does not.
D	Absolute language	Socialization continues throughout life.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A sociologist who studies a suburban school district ~~with new football stadiums~~ argues that standardized testing mostly helps wealthier families keep their advantages, because they can pay for test prep. ~~The district has 14 schools.~~ Which perspective is she using?

Target word: name the perspective **Decides:** Focus on who benefits and how inequality is maintained.

A	Confusion set	Functionalism would stress how testing sorts talent and supports stability.
B	Confusion set	That focuses on meanings in interaction, like how students see test labels.
C	Correct	It asks how institutions preserve advantage for powerful groups.
D	Camouflage	The stadium detail does not reflect her argument.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A researcher studies how a “gifted” label changes the way students see themselves and how teachers talk to them day to day. Which perspective fits this research?

Target word: perspective from question **Decides:** Meanings created in everyday interaction.

A	Confusion set	Functionalism looks at society-wide structures and stability.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the micro focus into a macro one.
C	Adjacent category	Conflict theory would focus on who gains from the gifted program.
D	Correct	It examines meanings, labels, and face-to-face interaction.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A mid-level bank employee ~~who drives a used sedan and coaches youth soccer~~ badly wants to be wealthy, a goal his culture praises. Seeing no path through promotions, he begins embezzling funds. In Merton's terms, which adaptation is this?

Target word: name the adaptation **Decides:** Accepts the goal, rejects legitimate means.

A	Confusion set	Retreatists reject both goals and means.
B	Correct	He pursues the approved goal through illegitimate means.
C	Confusion set	Rebels replace goals and means with new ones.
D	Inverted operation	Ritualism is the reverse: follow the means, abandon the goal.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A government clerk long ago gave up on promotion but still follows every procedure exactly, day after day. Which of Merton's adaptations is this?

Target word: name the adaptation **Decides:** Rejects the goal, keeps the means.

A	Correct	Holding to the rules after abandoning the goal is ritualism.
B	Dropped element	Conformity requires still pursuing the goal.
C	Adjacent category	Retreatists abandon the means too.
D	Inverted operation	Innovation keeps the goal and drops the means — the reverse.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A 15-year-old ~~who plays trumpet in the school band~~ is caught shoplifting once. Teachers, neighbors, and the local paper start calling him a “troublemaker.” Over the next year he joins other labeled teens and begins to see himself as a delinquent. ~~His family recently moved across town.~~ What does labeling theory call his later behavior?

Target word: name the stage **Decides:** Label internalized and shaping behavior.

A	Camouflage	The move is not what the theory points to.
B	Correct	Deviance that follows from accepting the label is secondary.
C	Inverted operation	Primary deviance was the first act, before the label took hold.
D	Confusion set	A strain-theory term, not labeling theory.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A sales rep at a ~~busy regional~~ office keeps interrupting colleagues in meetings. Coworkers start rolling their eyes, joking about it, and leaving him off lunch invitations. ~~The office recently switched to open seating.~~ What form of social control are the coworkers using?

Target word: formal or informal **Decides:** Unofficial reactions from peers.

A	Inverted operation	Positive sanctions reward behavior; these punish it.
B	Dropped element	Drops informal control, which needs no written rule.
C	Correct	Ridicule and exclusion by peers are informal sanctions.
D	Adjacent category	Formal sanctions go through official rules, like a written warning.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

Which of the following is an example of a formal sanction?

Target word: identify formal sanction **Decides:** Applied through an official process.

A	Confusion set	Informal and positive.
B	Inverted operation	That is an informal sanction.
C	Correct	Official action under a formal rule is a formal sanction.
D	Adjacent category	A teacher's frown is unofficial, despite the teacher's role.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A state licensing office ~~with modern computers and a newly painted lobby~~ requires three separate forms, each signed by a different clerk, before renewing a license. Staff will not skip a step even when an applicant has already provided the same information. Which idea best explains this?

Target word: name the pattern **Decides:** Rules followed even when they defeat the goal.

A	Camouflage	The office has modern computers; the cause is the rules.
B	Absolute language	Bureaucracies are often efficient; rigidity is a risk, not a rule.
C	Inverted operation	The office has too many rules, not too few.
D	Correct	Weber's model predicts efficiency but also rigid rule-following.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A group ~~founded by college students in a Midwestern city~~ campaigns for a state law requiring paid family leave. It holds rallies, lobbies legislators, and has a popular social media page ~~with 200,000 followers~~. It does not seek to change the economic system. What type of movement is it?

Target word: classify the movement **Decides:** Limited change at the level of society.

A	Correct	It seeks a specific change in society without overturning it.
B	Confusion set	Redemptive movements seek total change within individuals.
C	Confusion set	Alternative movements seek limited change in individuals, not laws.
D	Adjacent category	Revolutionary movements seek total societal change; this one does not.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	12	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Types of norms	Folkways are everyday customs with mild sanctions; mores are norms with strong moral weight and serious sanctions; taboos are mores so strong the act is unthinkable; laws are norms formally enacted and enforced by the state.	Calling any rule people feel strongly about a law, or any custom a more.	How strongly others react to the violation and whether the state enforces it.
2	Agents of socialization	Family is the primary agent in early childhood; schools, peers, media, religion, and workplaces are secondary agents that teach roles and norms later in life.	Assuming socialization ends in childhood or happens only in families.	Where and when the person is learning the norms.
3	Three theoretical perspectives	Functionalism asks how a structure keeps society stable; conflict theory asks who benefits and how inequality is maintained; symbolic interactionism asks how people create meaning in face-to-face interaction.	Mixing up the question each perspective asks.	Stability and functions vs. power and inequality vs. meanings and symbols.
4	Merton's strain theory	Deviance arises when people accept or reject culturally approved goals and the legitimate means to reach them: conformity (both accepted), innovation (goal, not means), ritualism (means, not goal), retreatism (reject both), rebellion (replace both).	Confusing innovation with ritualism.	Whether the person still pursues the goal and whether they use approved means.
5	Labeling theory	Primary deviance is an initial act that does not change a person's self-image; secondary deviance follows when others' label is internalized and shapes further behavior.	Treating deviance as a quality of the act alone rather than of the social reaction.	A label applied by others that the person comes to accept.
6	Formal vs. informal social control	Formal sanctions are official, applied by organizations or the state (fines, firing, arrest); informal sanctions are unofficial reactions by others (praise, ridicule, gossip, shunning).	Treating any negative reaction from a boss or teacher as formal.	Whether the response comes through an official rule and process.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
7	Weber's bureaucracy	Bureaucracies are marked by hierarchy, division of labor, written rules, impersonality, and merit-based careers; they are efficient but can become rigid, putting rules ahead of goals.	Assuming bureaucracy means inefficiency by definition.	An organization following written procedures even when they defeat the purpose.
8	Types of social movements	Reform movements seek limited change in society; revolutionary movements seek total change; redemptive movements seek total change in individuals; alternative movements seek limited change in individuals.	Calling any movement that wants a new law revolutionary.	Who is to change (individuals or society) and how much (limited or total).

Course scope (public description): This course teaches students to think like sociologists, or, in other words, to see and understand the hidden rules, or norms, by which people live, and how they free or restrain behavior. Students will learn about socializing institutions, such as schools and families, as well as workplace organizations and governments. Participants will also learn how people deviate from the rules by challenging norms and how such behavior may result in social change, either on a large scale or within small groups.